

CHRIST HIDDEN IN PLAIN SIGHT

How the Whole Old Testament Was Pointing to Jesus All Along

“Beginning from Moses and from all the prophets, he explained to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself.”

Luke 24:27 (WEB)

HOPE OF GLORY MINISTRY

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A Note on the Scriptures

Every verse in this book is quoted from the **World English Bible (WEB)**, a public-domain translation that anyone may read, copy, and share freely — a free Bible for a free gospel. The WEB also renders the divine name as "**Yahweh**," which helps when we are tracing the God of the Old Testament into the New.

This is a book about reading the Bible the way Jesus read it. You do not need to be a scholar. You need only be willing to follow the thread.

A Note to Every Reader

There are two ways to read the Old Testament. The first is to read it as a closed museum — a collection of ancient laws, wars, and poems with no particular destination. The second is to read it the way Jesus and His apostles read it: as a single unfolding story that was, from the first page, leaning forward toward a person.

This book makes the second case. It argues that the Old Testament is not a different religion that got replaced, nor a long preface that can be skipped, but a portrait being painted slowly, in layers, over centuries — and that when the subject of the portrait finally walked into the room, those with eyes to see recognized Him.

To the Christian: this will deepen your confidence that the Bible is one book with one Author and one center.

To the doubter: read the texts and judge for yourself whether the pattern is real or imagined. We will show our work.

To the Jewish reader: these are your Scriptures, read with the deepest respect. We believe they point to the Messiah; you may disagree. We will never caricature your tradition, and we will quote the texts honestly. Read, and weigh.

We compare readings; we never demean people. Here is the claim of the whole book, in one line: *the Old Testament is Christ hidden in plain sight*.

Chapter One — The Reading Lesson on the Road

Two travelers and a stranger

On the first Easter afternoon, two disciples walk the seven miles from Jerusalem to a village called Emmaus, talking about the catastrophe of the weekend — the execution of the teacher they had hoped was the Messiah. A stranger joins them. They do not recognize Him. And then He does something extraordinary: He gives them a Bible study.

"Beginning from Moses and from all the prophets, he explained to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself." — Luke 24:27 (WEB)

The stranger is the risen Jesus. And His claim is staggering: that "all the Scriptures" — the Law of Moses, the Prophets, the Psalms — are, in some real sense, "concerning himself." Later that evening, when their eyes are opened and He vanishes, they say to each other: "Weren't our hearts burning within us, while he spoke to us by the way, and while he opened the Scriptures to us?" (Luke 24:32).

That is the reading lesson this whole book is built on. Jesus did not treat the Old Testament as an outdated rulebook. He treated it as a portrait of Himself that His own people had been looking at without seeing.

The method, in His own words

Jesus said it directly to His critics: "You search the Scriptures, because you think that in them you have eternal life; and these are they which testify about me" (John 5:39). And again: "If you believed Moses, you would believe me; for he wrote about me" (John 5:46).

So we are not inventing a Christian gimmick of finding Jesus under every rock. We are following the explicit method of Jesus and His apostles, who read the Hebrew Scriptures as a forward-leaning testimony. The apostle Paul summarized the whole gospel as something that happened "according to the Scriptures" (1 Corinthians 15:3-4) — meaning the Old Testament Scriptures, the only ones the church had at first.

Four ways the Old Testament points forward

To read well, it helps to know the four threads we will be following:

Direct prophecy. Statements that predict — a ruler from Judah (Genesis 49:10), a child born in Bethlehem (Micah 5:2), a suffering servant (Isaiah 53), one pierced whom they would mourn (Zechariah 12:10).

Types and patterns. People and events shaped like Christ before He came: a beloved son offered up, a rejected brother who saves, a lamb whose blood turns away death, a bronze serpent lifted up. The New Testament calls these "a shadow of the things to come; but the body is Christ's" (Colossians 2:17).

The covenants. God's promises to Adam, Noah, Abraham, Moses, and David — each one advancing a single plan that comes to a head in Jesus.

The longings. The unfinished ache of the whole Old Testament: a better priest, a better king, a better sacrifice, a returned presence of God, a circumcised heart. The Old Testament keeps raising hopes it cannot itself satisfy.

A word of caution

Reading Christ in the Old Testament can be done badly — by force, by allegorical fancy, by ignoring what a text meant to its first hearers. We will try to be careful. A real type resembles Christ in a way the New Testament itself confirms or that the pattern plainly bears. We are not playing word games; we are tracing a design.

So let us begin where the Bible begins, with a promise made in the ruins of the first disaster.

How a type actually works

Before we walk the road, we need one tool in hand, or we will misuse everything that follows. A *type* is a real person, event, or institution in the Old Testament that God designed to prefigure a greater reality in Christ — what the New Testament calls a "shadow." The key word is *shadow*, because it tells us both that the resemblance is real and that the shadow is not the thing itself:

"These are a shadow of the things to come; but the body is Christ's." — Colossians 2:17 (WEB)

A shadow genuinely corresponds to the object that casts it — a man's shadow is shaped like a man, not a horse. So the types really do resemble Christ; the correspondence is not invented. But a shadow is also thinner than the reality, and it disappears once the substance arrives. That is exactly how the New Testament reads the tabernacle ("a copy and shadow of the heavenly things," Hebrews 8:5) and the law ("a shadow of the good things to come, and not the very image," Hebrews 10:1).

This gives us two guardrails. First, we are not free to find Christ by force in random details; a true type is one the text's own pattern bears and that Scripture confirms. Second, once the substance has come, we do not go back to living in the shadows — the lamb, the priest, the temple have done their work by pointing us to Him. With that tool in hand, we can walk the road safely, watching the shadow take the shape of a man long before the Man arrives.

You can search the Scriptures and still miss Him

There is a sobering warning attached to this whole way of reading, and Jesus spoke it to the most expert Bible students of His day. The scribes and Pharisees knew the Old Testament by heart — they could recite it, debate it, count its letters — and they missed the One it was about, standing in front of them. Jesus said to their faces:

"You search the Scriptures, because you think that in them you have eternal life; and these are they which testify about me; yet you will not come to me, that you may have life." — John 5:39-40 (WEB)

Read that carefully, because it is possible to do everything this book recommends — trace the types, master the patterns, admire the portrait — and still never meet the Person. The Pharisees treated the Scriptures as an end in themselves, a body of knowledge to possess, rather than a finger pointing to a Savior to receive. They had the map and refused the journey; they studied the menu and would not eat.

So this book comes with a caution as well as an invitation. The goal is not to make you clever about the Old Testament. The goal is for the portrait to do to you what it did to the disciples on the Emmaus road — to make your heart burn, and to send you running to the risen Christ Himself. Knowledge of the Bible that does not bring you to Jesus has missed the entire point. The Scriptures are the witnesses; He is the One they testify about. Do not stop at the witnesses. Come to Him.

Chapter Two — The Seed of the Woman

A promise spoken to a serpent

Humanity's first day outside the garden is also the day of the first promise. God speaks judgment over the serpent, and inside that judgment He hides a gospel:

"I will put hostility between you and the woman, and between your offspring and her offspring. He will bruise your head, and you will bruise his heel." — Genesis 3:15 (WEB)

Read it slowly. There will be a "seed" — an offspring — of the woman, who will crush the serpent's head, though He will be wounded ("bruise his heel") in doing it. Christians have called this verse the *protoevangelium*, "the first gospel," because the whole story of redemption is folded inside it: an offspring of the woman, a mortal wound to the enemy, and a cost to the deliverer. Long before a single law was given, the hope of a coming deliverer was planted.

The narrowing of the seed

From that point, the Old Testament does something fascinating: it keeps narrowing the line of the promised "seed." Through Seth, through Noah, and then to a wandering man named Abraham, to whom God promises: "in you all the families of the earth will be blessed" (Genesis 12:3). The blessing for *all nations* will come through Abraham's offspring.

Here the apostle Paul makes an observation about the Hebrew text that has provoked debate ever since — and that sits right at the heart of your own study. God's promises were spoken "to Abraham and to his seed." Paul writes:

"He doesn't say, 'To descendants,' as of many, but as of one, 'and to your offspring,' which is Christ." — Galatians 3:16 (WEB)

Paul notices that the promise word is **singular** — "seed," not "seeds." His point is not a grammar trick; the Hebrew word *zera* (seed) can be collective. His point is theological: the entire promise to Abraham funnels down, finally, to **one** descendant in whom the blessing of all nations actually arrives — the Messiah. The many are blessed only because of the One.

The son who carried the wood

Then comes one of the most haunting scenes in all of Scripture. God tests Abraham, telling him to offer his beloved son Isaac on a mountain in the land of Moriah. Watch the details, because the New Testament will later light them up:

- The father takes his only beloved son to a mountain (Genesis 22:2).
- Isaac himself **carries the wood** for the offering up the hill (Genesis 22:6) — as Jesus would carry His own cross.
- Isaac asks, "where is the lamb?" and Abraham answers by faith, "God will provide himself the lamb" (Genesis 22:7-8).
- At the last second a substitute is provided — a ram caught in a thicket — and Isaac lives.

Abraham names the place "Yahweh Will Provide," and the narrator adds, "as it is said to this day, 'On Yahweh's mountain, it will be provided'" (Genesis 22:14). Centuries later, on a hill in that same region, another beloved Son would carry the wood up the mountain — and this time there would be no ram in the thicket, because *He* was the Lamb God provided. The pattern set on Moriah was waiting for its fulfillment.

The scepter that would not depart

As the patriarch Jacob blesses his sons, he speaks a strange prophecy over Judah:

"The scepter will not depart from Judah, nor the ruler's staff from between his feet, until he comes to whom it belongs. To him will the obedience of the peoples be." — Genesis 49:10 (WEB)

A ruler is coming from the tribe of Judah to whom the obedience of *the peoples* — the nations — belongs. The seed of the woman, the offspring of Abraham, will be a king from Judah. The portrait is gaining features. Now it needs a face, and the next layer of the Old Testament gives us one — in the most unexpected of brothers.

"The seed of the woman"

Linger on a strange phrase in that first promise. God says the deliverer will be the offspring "of the woman" (Genesis 3:15). In a world that traced descent through fathers, this is unusual wording — the seed *of the woman*. It hangs in the air for thousands of years until a prophet sharpens it into a sign:

"Behold, the virgin will conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel." — Isaiah 7:14 (WEB)

A son born of a virgin — "God with us." And the New Testament closes the circuit with a phrase chosen to echo Eden: when the fullness of time came, God sent forth His Son, "born of a woman" (Galatians 4:4). Not "born of a man and a woman," but, pointedly, "born of a woman" — the seed of the woman at last, conceived by the Holy Spirit, entering the human family from the inside to crush the serpent's head from within.

This matters for more than poetry. The deliverer had to be truly one of us — a real human being, the woman's own offspring — to stand in our place and undo what the first man did. "For since death came by man, the resurrection of the dead also came by man" (1 Corinthians 15:21). The seed of the woman is the last Adam, born into our race to win back what the first Adam lost. The promise spoken in the ruins of Eden was waiting for a virgin's "yes" and a manger in Bethlehem.

The kinsman who buys back

Why did the deliverer have to be born into the family at all — why a *kinsman*? Israel's law gives the answer in a beautiful institution: the *goel*, the kinsman-redeemer. If an Israelite fell into debt or slavery or lost the family land, a near relative had the right and the duty to step in and "redeem" — to pay the price and buy back what was lost (Leviticus 25:47-49). The redeemer had to be a *relative*; a stranger could not do it. The book of Ruth turns this into a love story: Boaz, the kinsman-redeemer, buys back the lost inheritance and takes the destitute widow Ruth as his bride — and from that union comes King David, and in time, the Messiah.

This is why the seed had to be "born of a woman," one of our own blood. We had sold ourselves into slavery to sin and forfeited our inheritance, and only a kinsman could buy us back. So the eternal Son became our relative — "he himself in the same way partook of" flesh and blood, "that through death he might... deliver" us (Hebrews 2:14-15). And from the depth of his suffering, Job had already cried out in hope of exactly such a Redeemer:

"But as for me, I know that my Redeemer lives. In the end, he will stand upon the earth. After my skin is destroyed, then I will see God in my flesh." — Job 19:25-26 (WEB)

"My Redeemer lives... I will see God in my flesh." Job, in his ash heap, was reaching for a living Kinsman-Redeemer who would one day stand upon the earth — and would let him see God. The seed of the woman is that Redeemer: near enough to be our brother, able to pay the price, willing to take the ruined and the widowed as His own bride.

Chapter Three — Joseph, the Rejected Brother Who Saves

A story too shaped to be an accident

The longest single story in Genesis is the story of Joseph — and it is told with such deliberate shape that the New Testament writers, and Jesus Himself, treat the pattern of the rejected-brother-who-saves as one of the deep grooves of Scripture. Lay Joseph's life beside the life of Jesus and the resemblance is hard to unsee.

- Joseph is the **beloved son** of his father, sent to his brothers (Genesis 37:3, 13). Jesus is the beloved Son sent to His own (John 1:11).
- His brothers **hate him** and reject his dreams of authority (Genesis 37:8). Jesus' own people reject His kingship.
- He is **sold for silver** — twenty pieces — by his brother Judah's idea (Genesis 37:26-28). Jesus is sold for thirty pieces of silver by Judas (a Greek form of Judah).
- He is **condemned with two prisoners**, one who lives and one who dies (Genesis 40). Jesus is crucified between two criminals, one who turns to Him and one who does not.
- He is exalted from the prison to the **right hand of the throne**, given a new name, and all must bow the knee to him (Genesis 41:40-43). Jesus is raised from death to the right hand of God, given the name above every name, before whom every knee will bow.
- And finally, the saving turn: the brothers who betrayed him come to him in their hunger, and he **forgives** them and feeds them and weeps over them.

"You meant evil... God meant it for good"

The theological heart of the Joseph story is a single sentence he speaks to the brothers who sold him into slavery:

"As for you, you meant evil against me, but God meant it for good, to save many people alive, as is happening today." — Genesis 50:20 (WEB)

This is the logic of the cross written centuries early. Wicked human hands do their worst; God, without excusing the evil, weaves it into the rescue of many. Peter would preach exactly this about Jesus at Pentecost: "him, being delivered up by the determined counsel and foreknowledge of God, you have... crucified and killed" (Acts 2:23). The betrayal was real and guilty. The salvation was real and sovereign. Joseph is the pattern; Christ is the substance.

Why the pattern matters

Notice what is happening across these chapters. Long before there is a doctrine of atonement, the Bible is teaching its readers a *shape* — the shape of a beloved son, rejected by his own, descending into a pit and a prison, raised to a throne, and using his exaltation to forgive and feed the very people who betrayed him. By the time Jesus arrives, the shape is familiar to anyone soaked in Scripture. He does not break the pattern. He fulfills it.

The Old Testament keeps doing this — teaching us the melody so that we will recognize the song when the singer finally comes. The next layer teaches it through blood.

The stone the builders rejected

Joseph is not the only rejected-deliverer in the pattern; he is one note in a chord the whole Old Testament keeps striking. Moses, too, was rejected by his own people before he saved them — Stephen makes the point pointedly: "This Moses, whom they refused, saying, 'Who made you a ruler and a judge?' — God has sent him as both ruler and deliverer" (Acts 7:35). Rejection, then deliverance: it happens again and again, until a psalm turns it into a proverb about a stone:

"The stone which the builders rejected has become the head of the corner. This is Yahweh's doing. It is marvelous in our eyes." — Psalm 118:22-23 (WEB)

The builders — the ones whose job is to know which stones matter — throw one aside as worthless, and it turns out to be the cornerstone, the very stone the whole building depends on. Jesus quoted this verse about Himself at the climax of His conflict with the religious leaders (Matthew 21:42), and the apostles made it a centerpiece of their preaching: "He is 'the stone which was regarded as worthless by you, the builders, which has become the head of the corner'" (Acts 4:11). The pattern set in Joseph — rejected by his brothers, exalted to save them — is the shape of the Messiah Himself: "He came to his own, and those who were his own didn't receive him" (John 1:11), and that very rejection became the world's salvation. The builders threw Him away. God made Him the cornerstone.

Chapter Four — The Lamb and the Exodus

A nation born through blood

The defining event of the Old Testament — the one Israel would remember every year forever — is the Exodus from Egypt. And at its center is a lamb.

On the night of the final plague, every household in Egypt is under the same sentence of death. Israel is not spared because they are better; they are spared because of blood. Each family is to take a lamb "without defect" (Exodus 12:5), kill it, and put its blood on the doorposts. God's word is precise:

"The blood shall be to you for a token on the houses where you are. When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will be on you to destroy you." — Exodus 12:13 (WEB)

Notice what saves them. Not their worthiness, not their effort — the blood of a substitute, applied to the door. Death still comes that night; it simply falls on the lamb instead of the firstborn. Israel walks out of slavery the next morning as a people redeemed by blood.

"Behold, the Lamb of God"

For fifteen hundred years, Israel kept the Passover, eating the lamb, telling the story, waiting. Then a prophet named John saw Jesus walking toward him and said seven words that detonate the whole pattern:

"Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" — John 1:29 (WEB)

The Lamb. Not *a* lamb — *the* Lamb, the one all the others had been pointing to. Paul says it without flinching: "For indeed Christ, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place" (1 Corinthians 5:7). And John's Gospel notes that Jesus died at Passover, and that, like the Passover lamb, "a bone of him will not be broken" (John 19:36, citing Exodus 12:46). The timing was not a coincidence. It was an appointment kept.

The serpent lifted up

The Exodus generation gives us one more startling picture. When venomous serpents bite the grumbling people in the wilderness, God's remedy is strange: Moses makes a bronze serpent, lifts it on a pole, and "if a serpent had bitten any man, when he looked to the serpent of

bronze, he lived" (Numbers 21:9). They are not healed by working harder; they are healed by *looking* in faith at the lifted-up cure.

Jesus reached back and grabbed this exact image to explain His own death:

"As Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of Man be lifted up, that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life." — John 3:14-15 (WEB)

The serpent — the symbol of the curse from Genesis 3 — is lifted up, and the dying live by looking. On the cross, the One who "knew no sin" was "made to be sin on our behalf" (2 Corinthians 5:21), lifted up so that all who look to Him in faith will live. The wilderness was rehearsing Calvary.

The portrait now has blood in it, and a way of salvation: a substitute, a lifted-up cure, a people redeemed not by effort but by faith. Next the Old Testament builds Him a house — and shows us it was only ever a model.

The greater Exodus

The Exodus was so clearly the pattern of salvation that the prophets began to speak of a *new* and greater Exodus still to come — and the Gospels deliberately frame Jesus' death as exactly that. On the Mount of Transfiguration, when Moses and Elijah appear with Jesus, Luke tells us precisely what they discussed:

"[They] appeared in glory, and spoke of his departure, which he was about to accomplish at Jerusalem." — Luke 9:31 (WEB)

The word translated "departure" is, in the Greek, *exodos* — His "exodus." Moses, who led the first Exodus, stands beside Jesus and speaks of the greater one Jesus is about to accomplish at Jerusalem. The first Exodus brought Israel out of slavery to Pharaoh through the blood of a lamb and the waters of the sea; the new Exodus would bring a people out of slavery to sin and death through the blood of *the* Lamb and the waters of a borrowed tomb. Isaiah had promised it — a second, greater rescue surpassing the first (Isaiah 43:16-19) — and Jesus walked into Jerusalem at Passover to lead it. To read the Exodus rightly is to see it leaning forward, the whole time, toward a cross and an empty grave.

"Out of Egypt I called my son"

There is a phrase about the Exodus that the New Testament picks up in a way that, at first, looks like a stretch — until you see the pattern. Looking back on the Exodus, God said

through Hosea:

*"When Israel was a child, then I loved him, and called my son out of Egypt." —
Hosea 11:1 (WEB)*

In Hosea this plainly means *Israel* — God's "son" (Exodus 4:22) — brought out of Egypt. Yet Matthew quotes it of the child Jesus, carried to Egypt to escape Herod and then brought back: "that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the Lord through the prophet, saying, 'Out of Egypt I called my son'" (Matthew 2:15). Is Matthew misusing the verse? No — he has grasped something profound: *Jesus is the true Israel*. Where the nation God called His "son" failed in the wilderness, grumbling and rebelling, Jesus, the true Son, retraces Israel's steps and succeeds — driven into the wilderness, tested forty days, refusing the rebellion Israel committed. He is everything Israel was meant to be and was not. So Israel's own history becomes prophetic: the son called out of Egypt, the people passed through the waters, the nation tested in the desert — all of it was a shadow of the true Son who would relive and redeem the whole story. To read Israel's history rightly is to watch it rehearse, in advance, the life of her Messiah.

Chapter Five — Moses, the Tabernacle, and the Pattern of Heaven

A tent built from a blueprint

After the Exodus, God gives Moses elaborate instructions for a tent of worship — the tabernacle — and later the temple. Why does the Bible spend so many chapters on curtains, furniture, and priestly robes? The New Testament gives the reason, and it changes everything:

"They serve a copy and shadow of the heavenly things, even as Moses was warned by God... 'See, you shall make everything according to the pattern that was shown to you on the mountain.'" — Hebrews 8:5 (WEB)

The tabernacle was never the real thing. It was a scale model of a heavenly reality, built "according to the pattern." Every piece was a teaching aid: the altar where blood was shed, the laver for washing, the bread of the presence, the lampstand, the veil, and behind the veil the ark where God's presence dwelt. The whole structure said one thing over and over: a holy God will dwell with sinful people, but only through sacrifice, cleansing, and a mediator.

The veil and the access

At the center of the tabernacle hung a thick veil, separating the people from the Most Holy Place where God's presence rested. Only the high priest could pass through it, once a year, with blood. The message was unmistakable: the way to God is not yet open.

Then, at the moment Jesus died, Matthew records that "the veil of the temple was torn in two from the top to the bottom" (Matthew 27:51). From the top — as if torn by a hand from above, not below. The book of Hebrews explains the meaning: through His flesh, Jesus has opened "a new and living way" through the veil, so that we may now "draw near with a true heart in fullness of faith" (Hebrews 10:20-22). The model had a locked door for fifteen centuries. The reality flung it open.

Moses and the better Mediator

Moses himself becomes a pattern of Christ. He is the mediator who stands between God and the people, the prophet who speaks God's words, the deliverer who leads them out of bondage. And remarkably, Moses prophesies that he is *not* the final word:

"Yahweh your God will raise up to you a prophet from among you, of your brothers, like me. You shall listen to him." — Deuteronomy 18:15 (WEB)

A prophet "like Moses" was coming, and Israel was to listen to *Him*. The New Testament identifies that prophet as Jesus (Acts 3:22). But the comparison cuts both ways, for Hebrews insists Jesus is *greater* than Moses — Moses was "faithful in all God's house as a servant," but Christ is faithful "as a Son over his house" (Hebrews 3:5-6). Moses could lead Israel out of Egypt; he could not lead them into the Promised Land — that fell to Joshua (in Hebrew, *Yeshua*, the same name as "Jesus"). The law given through Moses could expose the problem; only Jesus could bring the people home.

The portrait now has a temple, a torn veil, and a mediator greater than Moses. Next the Old Testament gives Him a crown.

Bread, water, and the Rock that followed

The wilderness itself was a portrait gallery. Israel ate bread from heaven each morning — manna — and drank water from a struck rock, and the New Testament reads both as shadows of Christ. Jesus took the manna and made it about Himself: "I am the bread of life... the bread which comes down out of heaven, that anyone may eat of it and not die" (John 6:48-50). And Paul, astonishingly, identifies the rock that gave water in the desert as Christ Himself:

"[They] all drank the same spiritual drink. For they drank of a spiritual rock that followed them, and the rock was Christ." — 1 Corinthians 10:4 (WEB)

The rock had to be *struck* before the water flowed (Exodus 17:6) — and when, later, Moses struck it a second time instead of merely speaking to it, his disobedience kept him from the Promised Land, because he marred the picture: the Rock is struck *once*, and thereafter the water flows freely to all who ask. Christ, the true Rock, was struck once at Calvary, and from His pierced side flowed the living water for a thirsty world. Bread for the hungry, water for the parched, light in the pillar of fire by night — at every point of need in the wilderness, God was sketching the Christ who would one day say, "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink" (John 7:37). The desert was full of Him.

Chapter Six — The King: David, Goliath, and the Son of David

A shepherd-king from Bethlehem

God chooses an unlikely shepherd boy from Bethlehem named David and makes him king, then makes him a promise that towers over the rest of the Old Testament:

"Your house and your kingdom will be made sure forever before you. Your throne will be established forever." — 2 Samuel 7:16 (WEB)

A son of David would have an *everlasting* throne. But David died, and so did every son who sat on his throne, and eventually the throne itself was lost in exile. The promise hung unfulfilled over Israel for a thousand years, a debt God had pledged to pay. The prophets kept the hope alive — a child would be born, "and the government will be on his shoulders... Of the increase of his government and of peace there shall be no end, on David's throne" (Isaiah 9:6-7).

When the angel comes to Mary, he reaches straight back to that thousand-year-old promise: "the Lord God will give to him the throne of his father David... and of his Kingdom there will be no end" (Luke 1:32-33). The crowds who shouted "Hosanna to the son of David!" knew exactly what they were claiming. The Bethlehem shepherd's greater Son had come.

David, Goliath, and Golgotha

One of your own Scroll threads sits here — the strange resonance between David's most famous battle and the place of the cross. The pattern is worth seeing.

David faces Goliath not as one soldier among many but as Israel's *representative*: the whole nation's fate rests on one man's victory, and when he wins, the people share in a triumph they did not fight for (1 Samuel 17). He strikes the giant in the head — an echo of Genesis 3:15, the seed crushing the serpent's head — using the enemy's own weapon, and he does it in "the valley of Elah" before a watching army.

There is even a curious geographical thread: David takes the head of the Philistine champion to Jerusalem (1 Samuel 17:54), and the place of the skull — *Golgotha* — is where the true Son of David would one day win the decisive single-combat victory over the true enemy, again as the people's representative, again by what looked like weakness, again striking the serpent's head while taking a wound Himself. We hold such patterns humbly — Scripture

does not spell out every link — but the shape is unmistakable: one representative champion, a victory the people share without earning, a blow to the head of the enemy in the place of the skull.

The King who is also the Lord

David himself wrote something that Jesus used to stump the experts. In Psalm 110, David writes, "Yahweh says to my Lord, 'Sit at my right hand, until I make your enemies your footstool'" (Psalm 110:1). Jesus asked the teachers: if the Messiah is merely David's son, why does David call Him "my Lord"? (Matthew 22:41-46). The answer the Old Testament was driving toward is that the Son of David is also David's Lord — the human king who is somehow also divine. The crown the Old Testament forges for the Messiah is too heavy for a merely human head.

The portrait now wears David's crown. But there is one more layer — the deepest and most painful — where the Old Testament shows the King must first be a Lamb, a Priest, and a pierced Shepherd. To that we now turn.

The Good Shepherd the prophets promised

David was the shepherd-king — taken "from following the sheep" to shepherd Israel (2 Samuel 7:8) — but Israel's later kings shepherded badly, scattering and fleecing the flock. So God spoke through Ezekiel a promise with two halves that should not fit together, yet do. First, *God Himself* would come to shepherd His people:

"I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep... I will seek that which was lost, and will bring back that which was driven away, and will bind up that which was broken." — Ezekiel 34:15-16 (WEB)

And second, in the very same passage, God promises to set over them "one shepherd, my servant David" (Ezekiel 34:23) — a coming son of David who would shepherd them. So which is it: God Himself, or the Son of David? The answer, when He came, was *both at once*. Jesus, the Son of David, stood up and said, "I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep" (John 10:11) — taking up the very promise God had made about *Himself*. The shepherd-king of Bethlehem was a shadow of a greater Shepherd-King, who is both David's son and David's Lord, God come to seek the lost sheep in person. The crown the Old Testament forges for the Messiah keeps turning out to fit only the head of one who is both man and God.

The king who would also suffer

David gives us more than a royal line; he gives us, in his own psalms, the voice of a suffering anointed one — and the New Testament hears the Messiah speaking through him. David, hunted and betrayed though innocent, wrote songs of anguish that reach far beyond his own experience. Psalm 22 — "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?... they have pierced my hands and feet" — describes a death by crucifixion a thousand years before Jesus and centuries before the practice existed. Psalm 16 declares, "you will not... allow your holy one to see corruption" — which Peter says David could not have meant of himself (David's tomb was right there), but of the Messiah's resurrection (Acts 2:29-31).

And David's greatest psalm about the King is one in which the King is also a *priest forever* and David's own *Lord*:

"Yahweh says to my Lord, 'Sit at my right hand, until I make your enemies your footstool for your feet.'... Yahweh has sworn... 'You are a priest forever in the order of Melchizedek.'" — Psalm 110:1, 4 (WEB)

A King at God's right hand whom David calls "my Lord," and a King who is also an eternal Priest — Jesus pressed this very psalm on the experts (Matthew 22:41-45), and they could not answer. The shepherd-king of Bethlehem foreshadowed a King who would reign by first being pierced, who would conquer His enemies by dying for them, and who would wear both crown and priestly robe. David sang of his own sufferings, and in them the Spirit was sketching the sufferings of great David's greater Son.

Chapter Seven — The Priest, the Scapegoat, and the Pierced One

A priest from before the law

Long before Israel had priests, a mysterious figure meets Abraham: Melchizedek, "king of Salem" and "priest of God Most High," who brings out bread and wine and blesses him (Genesis 14:18-20). He appears from nowhere, with no recorded genealogy, and vanishes. Centuries later David writes that the Messiah will be "a priest forever, after the order of Melchizedek" (Psalm 110:4).

Why does this matter? Because Israel's regular priests came from the tribe of Levi, served until they died, and offered sacrifices that had to be repeated endlessly. The book of Hebrews seizes on Melchizedek to show that the Messiah is a *different kind* of priest — one who does not inherit the office from a dying father but holds it "by the power of an endless life" (Hebrews 7:16), one whose single sacrifice never needs repeating. Jesus is both the King from Judah *and* the Priest like Melchizedek — a combination no ordinary Israelite could ever hold. The bread and wine Melchizedek brought out hint at the table Jesus would one day spread.

The two goats and the Day of Atonement

On Israel's holiest day, the Day of Atonement, two goats were brought before the priest (Leviticus 16). One was sacrificed, its blood carried behind the veil to cover sin. The other — the "scapegoat" — had the people's sins confessed over its head and was then driven away into the wilderness, "and the goat shall carry on itself all their iniquities to a solitary land" (Leviticus 16:22).

Two goats, one redemption: one died to pay; one carried sin *away*. Together they say what one animal could not — that atonement both pays the penalty and removes the guilt as far as the east is from the west. Both meet in Jesus, who "was once offered to bear the sins of many" (Hebrews 9:28) and of whom John the Baptist said He "takes away the sin of the world." Your Scroll even traced the thread to Jesus' baptism, where the sinless One steps into the place of sinners — the One who would carry sin away begins by standing where the guilty stand.

"They will look to me whom they have pierced"

Now the prophets bring the portrait to its most astonishing focus. Isaiah, seven centuries before the cross, describes a servant who suffers not for His own sin but for ours:

"He was pierced for our transgressions. He was crushed for our iniquities. The punishment that brought our peace was on him; and by his wounds we are healed."
— Isaiah 53:5 (WEB)

Read the whole chapter and it is difficult to believe it was written *before* the event it describes: despised and rejected, silent before His accusers, "led like a lamb to the slaughter," numbered with transgressors, buried with the rich, and yet afterward seeing "the result of the suffering of his soul" (Isaiah 53:11). This is the Lamb, the substitute, the sin-bearer — sketched in advance.

And the prophet Zechariah, another of your study threads, adds a line that names the unthinkable. Speaking as God Himself, Yahweh says:

"They will look to me whom they have pierced; and they shall mourn for him, as one mourns for his only son." — Zechariah 12:10 (WEB)

Notice the pronouns: *they pierced me*, and they will mourn for *him* — God speaks of being pierced, and of the pierced one as a distinct "him," an only son. John quotes this verse at the foot of the cross, when the soldier's spear opens Jesus' side: "They will look on him whom they pierced" (John 19:37). The God of Israel said His people would one day look on the One they pierced. At Golgotha, they did.

The Son of Man on the clouds

Finally, the prophet Daniel sees the end of the story. In a night vision he watches "one like a son of man" come "with the clouds of the sky" to the Ancient of Days, and to this human-yet-heavenly figure is given "dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all the peoples, nations, and languages should serve him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion" (Daniel 7:13-14). The worship and everlasting kingdom that belong to God alone are given to "one like a son of man."

This was Jesus' favorite title for Himself — "the Son of Man" — and at His trial He claimed Daniel's vision outright: "you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of Power, and coming with the clouds of the sky" (Mark 14:62), for which He was condemned. The rejected Lamb and the enthroned Son of Man are the same person. The story that began with a promise to a serpent ends with a kingdom that never ends.

The Branch: priest and king in one

The prophets gave the coming One a quiet, recurring title: the **Branch** — a shoot growing up from the felled stump of David's fallen dynasty. And what they said about this Branch gathers the whole portrait into one figure. Zechariah is told to crown the high priest Joshua as a living sign, and to say:

"Behold, the man whose name is the Branch... he shall build Yahweh's temple. He shall bear the glory, and shall sit and rule on his throne. He shall be a priest on his throne." — Zechariah 6:12-13 (WEB)

"A priest on his throne." In Israel, this was unthinkable — the kings came from Judah, the priests from Levi, and no one could hold both offices; King Uzziah was struck with leprosy for daring to enter the priest's role (2 Chronicles 26:16-21). Yet the Branch would be *both* — king and priest at once, ruling from a throne and ministering at an altar. Only one figure in all of Scripture unites the two: the King after the order of Melchizedek, who is both Son of David and great High Priest. Jeremiah names this Branch with a name that says it all:

"I will raise to David a righteous Branch... and this is his name by which he will be called: Yahweh our righteousness." — Jeremiah 23:5-6 (WEB)

"Yahweh our righteousness" — the Branch is not only David's heir but bears the divine name, and *is* the righteousness His people need. King, Priest, and the Lord our righteousness, in one Person. The stump looked dead; David's line seemed finished in exile. But from the felled stump a Branch grew, and His name is Jesus.

The new heart the prophets promised

The portrait is not only of a person; it is of what that person would *accomplish* — and the prophets, gazing forward, saw the deepest need of all answered. The problem was never merely that Israel lacked good laws; it was that the human heart itself was bent. Outward rules cannot fix an inward rebellion. So the prophets promised something only God could do: a new covenant that would change the heart from the inside.

"I will make a new covenant... I will put my law in their inward parts, and write it in their heart... for I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more." — Jeremiah 31:31-34 (WEB)

"I will give you a new heart, and I will put a new spirit within you. I will take away the stony heart out of your flesh, and I will give you a heart of flesh." — Ezekiel 36:26 (WEB)

A new heart, a new spirit, the law written within, sins remembered no more — this is the summit of the Old Testament's longing, and it could not be reached by the old system of stone tablets and animal blood. It waited for the One who, on the night before He died, lifted a cup and said, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood" (Luke 22:20). The whole portrait — seed, lamb, priest, king, suffering servant — converges not merely on a figure to admire but on a salvation to receive: forgiveness that is final, and a heart made new by His Spirit. The Christ hidden in the Old Testament came to do the one thing the Old Testament could only promise — to write God's life on the human heart.

The portrait, unveiled

Step back and look at the finished portrait. The seed of the woman who crushes the serpent. The offspring of Abraham who blesses the nations. The beloved son carrying the wood up the mountain. The rejected brother who is sold for silver and saves those who betrayed him. The Passover Lamb whose blood turns away death. The serpent lifted up so the dying can look and live. The tabernacle's torn veil. The prophet greater than Moses. The Son of David with an everlasting throne. The Priest after the order of Melchizedek. The scapegoat who carries sin away. The Servant pierced for our transgressions. The pierced One whom Yahweh calls "me." The Son of Man on the clouds.

Every line was drawn before He came. That is why the two on the Emmaus road felt their hearts burning — not because the stranger invented a meaning, but because He finally read aloud the meaning that had been there all along.

So the question this book leaves you with is the question those travelers had to answer when their eyes were opened:

If the whole of the Old Testament was a portrait of this one Person — what will you do, now that you have seen His face?

Honest Questions

If the whole Old Testament really points to Jesus, fair questions follow. Here are the ones a thoughtful reader — believer or skeptic — should press, answered without dodging.

"Aren't Christians just reading Jesus back into texts that meant something else?"

It is a fair worry, and the safeguard is the method we set out in chapter one. We are not free to find Jesus anywhere we like. A responsible reading honors three things: what the text meant to its first hearers, how the New Testament itself handles it, and whether the pattern is really in the text or imposed on it. Many of the connections in this book are not Christian inventions at all — they are made *by the New Testament writers themselves* (Paul on the seed, Matthew on Isaiah 42, Hebrews on Melchizedek and the tabernacle, John on the Passover lamb). And several were seen as messianic by Jewish interpreters *before* Christ. We are following a trail, not bulldozing one.

"How do you know these are real patterns and not coincidences you cherry-picked?"

Two tests. First, *density*: a single resemblance might be coincidence, but dozens of independent lines — seed, lamb, priest, king, suffering servant, pierced one, son of man — all converging on one Person, across many centuries and authors who could not have coordinated, is not what coincidence looks like. Second, *direction*: the Old Testament does not merely happen to resemble Jesus; it openly *anticipates* — it makes promises (an everlasting throne, a new covenant, a pierced one mourned), raises hopes it cannot satisfy, and points forward. A coincidence does not leave a nation waiting. We also hold the looser patterns humbly and say so (as with David and Golgotha) — which is itself a check against cherry-picking.

"Jewish interpreters read these passages differently — Isaiah 53 is Israel, not the Messiah."

This is true and deserves respect, not dismissal. Some Jewish traditions read the Servant of Isaiah 53 as the nation of Israel suffering among the nations; others, both ancient and medieval, read it messianically. The text itself, read closely, strains the national reading: the Servant suffers *for the sins of the people* and is "cut off out of the land of the living for the

disobedience of my people" (Isaiah 53:8) — the Servant is distinguished *from* the people he suffers for, which is hard to square with Israel suffering for Israel. We do not claim the messianic reading is the only one ever held; we claim it is the most natural reading of the words, and the reading the New Testament and many before it embraced. We make the case from the text and leave the verdict to the honest reader.

"Is Paul's 'seed is singular' argument (Galatians 3:16) really fair to the Hebrew?"

A careful question. The Hebrew word *zera* ("seed/offspring") is grammatically collective — it can mean "descendants" generally, and often does. So Paul is not making a crude grammar claim that the word *must* be singular. His point is theological and contextual: the *promise* of worldwide blessing through Abraham's seed comes to its focus and fulfillment in *one* descendant, the Messiah, through whom alone the many become Abraham's children (Galatians 3:29). Paul is reading the whole trajectory of the promise, not just one word. The narrowing of the line — Seth, Shem, Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, Judah, David — was always funneling toward one.

"If Jesus fulfilled all this, why didn't more of His own people believe?"

Several honest reasons. First, the portrait had two faces the experts had trouble holding together — a conquering King *and* a suffering Servant — and many expected only the King, so a crucified Messiah looked like a contradiction (it took the resurrection, and Jesus' own teaching on the Emmaus road, to see that the Servant had to suffer *before* He reigned). Second, recognition is not merely intellectual; Scripture says spiritual sight is needed to see spiritual things. And third — the New Testament is honest that *many did* believe: the first thousands of Christians were Jews who knew these Scriptures intimately and became convinced precisely *because* of them (Acts 2–4). Belief and unbelief both ran through Israel, as they run through every people.

"If it's all in the Old Testament, why bother with the Old Testament now that Jesus has come?"

Because the Old Testament is not scaffolding to be torn down once the building stands; it is the very portrait that shows you who the building's Architect is. Jesus did not come to *replace* those Scriptures but to *fulfill* them — "I didn't come to destroy, but to fulfill" (Matthew 5:17) —

and to throw them away is to lose two-thirds of God's self-revelation and most of the depth of the gospel. You cannot fully understand the Lamb without the Passover, the cross without the sacrifices, the kingdom without David, the new covenant without Jeremiah. The earliest Christians had *only* the Old Testament as their Bible, and they found Christ on every page. We read it not to go back into the shadows, but because the shadows make the substance unmistakable — and because the same God who spoke "at many times and in various ways" through the prophets has "at the end of these days spoken to us by his Son" (Hebrews 1:1-2). To love Jesus is to love the Scriptures that are "able to make you wise for salvation through faith" in Him (2 Timothy 3:15).

"Why all the shadows? Why didn't God just send Jesus at the beginning?"

For the same reason a great teacher does not begin with the final, hardest truth, but prepares the class to receive it. The centuries of types and promises were God teaching the world its vocabulary — *sacrifice, covenant, kingship, priesthood, lamb, exodus, atonement* — so that when the reality arrived, His people would have eyes to recognize Him and minds to understand what He had done. Drop a stranger into the last act of a play and he is lost; the long buildup is what makes the climax land. The shadows also proved the plan was no improvisation: a salvation foretold across two thousand years, in dozens of authors who could not have colluded, all converging on one Person, is not an accident patched together after a failure — it is a design unfolding on purpose. The wait was not God being slow. It was God being a patient teacher, drawing the portrait line by line, so that when at last He said, "Behold," we would know the face.

Appendix — The Portrait in Key Texts

A reference table of the threads traced in this book.

The pattern	Old Testament	Fulfilled in Christ
Seed of the woman	Genesis 3:15	The offspring who crushes the serpent
Offspring of Abraham	Genesis 12:3; 22	Galatians 3:16; the beloved Son carrying the wood
Scepter from Judah	Genesis 49:10	The King to whom the nations belong
Rejected brother who saves	Genesis 37–50	Sold for silver; exalted to save those who betrayed Him
Passover lamb	Exodus 12	"Christ, our Passover" (1 Corinthians 5:7); John 1:29
Serpent lifted up	Numbers 21:9	"The Son of Man must be lifted up" (John 3:14)
The torn veil	Exodus 26; Leviticus 16	The veil torn at His death (Matthew 27:51)
Prophet like Moses	Deuteronomy 18:15	"You shall listen to him" (Acts 3:22)
Son of David, everlasting throne	2 Samuel 7:16	"Of his Kingdom there will be no end" (Luke 1:33)
Priest after Melchizedek	Psalms 110:4	A priest "by the power of an endless life" (Hebrews 7)
The scapegoat	Leviticus 16	"Bore the sins of many" (Hebrews 9:28)
The pierced Servant	Isaiah 53:5	"Pierced for our transgressions"
The pierced One mourned	Zechariah 12:10	"They will look on him whom they pierced" (John 19:37)
The Son of Man on the clouds	Daniel 7:13-14	Jesus' claim at His trial (Mark 14:62)

Conclusion — Come and See

The Old Testament is not a closed museum. It is a portrait gallery, and every hall leads to the same face. Jesus did not abolish the Hebrew Scriptures; He fulfilled them — "I didn't come to destroy, but to fulfill" (Matthew 5:17). He is the seed, the lamb, the temple, the prophet, the king, the priest, and the pierced Shepherd, gathered into one life, one death, and one resurrection.

Walk back down the gallery one last time. The covering God provided in Eden and the Redeemer Job longed to see "in my flesh." The seed of the woman, born of a virgin, the kinsman who buys us back. The beloved son carrying the wood up Moriah, and the rejected brother sold for silver who saves those who betrayed him — the very stone the builders threw away, become the cornerstone. The Passover Lamb on the door and the true Son called out of Egypt who succeeds where Israel failed. The Rock struck in the wilderness, the bread from heaven, the tabernacle's torn veil, the prophet greater than Moses. The shepherd-king of Bethlehem who is also the Good Shepherd God promised to be Himself; the suffering anointed of the Psalms; the Branch who is priest on his throne, named "Yahweh our righteousness." The Priest after Melchizedek, the scapegoat who carries sin away, the Servant pierced for our transgressions, the pierced One whom Yahweh calls "me," the Son of Man on the clouds — and, through it all, the promise of a new covenant and a new heart that only He could give.

It is one face, drawn over two thousand years by forty authors who could not have conspired, and every line was in place before He was born. That is not the work of coincidence; it is the signature of one Author behind the whole Book. And it means the Old Testament was never merely Israel's national history or a collection of moral tales. It was a long, patient unveiling — God teaching the world to recognize His Son.

If you are a believer, read your Old Testament again with these eyes, and let your heart burn. If you are still weighing it, do what the first disciples did — bring your doubt and "come and see" (John 1:46). And if you are ready, the whole portrait has only ever been inviting you to one thing:

*"Come to me, all you who labor and are heavily burdened, and I will give you rest."
— Matthew 11:28 (WEB)*

The One the Scriptures were pointing to is the One who is, even now, pointing back to you.

About this book

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"For the earth will be filled with the knowledge of the glory of Yahweh, as the waters cover the sea." — Habakkuk 2:14 (WEB)